IDC MarketScape

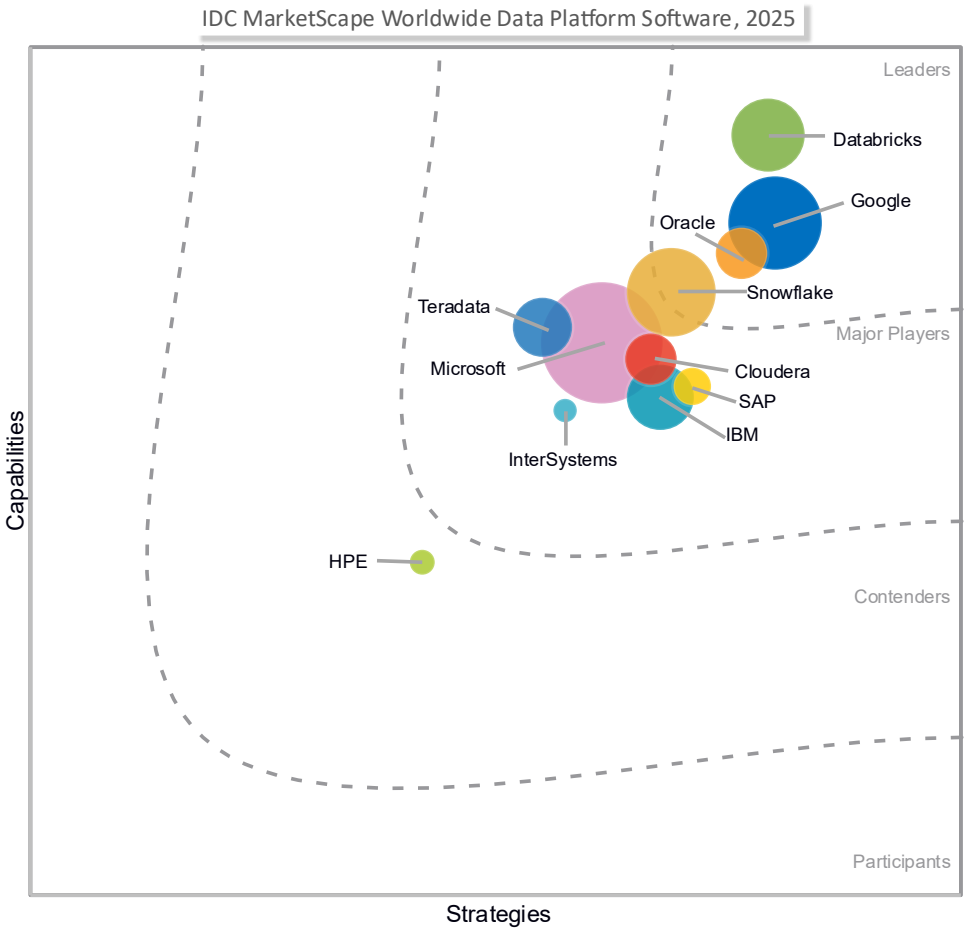
IDC MarketScape: Worldwide Data Platform Software 2025 Vendor Assessment

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IDC MARKETSCAPE FIGURE

FIGURE 1

IDC MarketScape Worldwide Data Platform Software Vendor Assessment



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Please see the Appendix for detailed methodology, market definition, and scoring criteria.

IDC OPINION

Organizations evaluating data platform software today face a critical inflection point where the convergence of artificial intelligence (AI) demands and data complexity is fundamentally reshaping purchase decisions. The traditional approach of selecting data platforms based solely on technical specifications is giving way to a more strategic evaluation focused on AI readiness, unified governance, and deployment flexibility. Technology buyers must recognize that modern data platforms serve as the foundational layer for enterprise AI initiatives, making the quality of data unification and governance capabilities as important as raw performance metrics. The rapid evolution toward data lakehouse architectures and the growing emphasis on open data formats reflect a market maturity where vendor lock-in concerns are driving buyers toward platforms that support portability and interoperability across hybrid and multicloud environments.

This IDC study represents the vendor assessment model called IDC MarketScape. This research is a quantitative and qualitative assessment of the characteristics that explain a vendor's success in the marketplace and help anticipate its ascendancy. This study assesses the capability and business strategy of many of the leading data platform software vendors. Key findings include:

- With organizations prioritizing data unification for AI initiatives, buyers should evaluate how well platforms integrate AI capabilities throughout the data life cycle rather than treating AI as an add-on feature. Platforms that embed AI for automated optimization, natural language querying, autonomous agents, and intelligent data discovery will provide competitive advantages as generative AI (GenAI) adoption accelerates. IDC data shows that data management is the second-highest priority among organizations shaping their AI strategies in 2025, underscoring the need for a unified data landscape that ensures data quality, trust, and compliance as AI becomes central to enterprise operations.
- The complexity of managing structured, semistructured, and unstructured data across multiple environments requires platforms with comprehensive governance frameworks that provide consistent policy enforcement, automated lineage tracking, and centralized metadata management without creating additional operational overhead.
- Interoperability has become a standard for data management, from strategic partnerships to deployment flexibility. Data platforms should offer genuine multicloud support, open format compatibility, and the ability to maintain

consistent governance across on-premises, private cloud, and public cloud deployments without sacrificing performance or functionality.

- With advancements in agentic AI and data processing automation, real-time data processing and streaming analytics capabilities are essential. The ability to process data as it enters the system is crucial for time-sensitive applications such as fraud detection, personalization, and operational monitoring, where delays can result in lost opportunities or increased risks.

IDC MARKETSCAPE VENDOR INCLUSION CRITERIA

A critical point in this research effort is to meet the following inclusion criteria:

- The vendor offers a data platform software as one product with capabilities for data storage, data ingestion, data transformation, data intelligence/governance, and data analysis. At a minimum, dedicated data storage (in the form of data warehouse or lakehouse architecture within the platform), data ingestion, and data transformation need to be native intellectual property (IP) of the software vendor. OEM-provided IP or available as a separate product offering is acceptable for data intelligence/governance and data analytics capabilities.
- The data platform software being evaluated by IDC is the strategic data platform solution for the vendor.
- The vendor has at least $25 million in revenue for 2024, specifically from the data platform software offering regardless of where it is deployed.
- The vendor operates in North America and recognizes a minimum 10% of revenue from the Americas, EMEA, and AP.

ADVICE FOR TECHNOLOGY BUYERS

- **Establish clear business requirements before vendor engagement:** Begin your evaluation process for data platform vendors by defining specific business objectives and use cases that the platform must support. Engage stakeholders across departments to understand their data needs and create measurable evaluation criteria that align with your strategic goals. As part of this foundational work, consider your organization's existing tools and technology stack, the teams who will interact with the platform, the different types of data personas involved, and your deployment preferences. This comprehensive approach should also include identifying key performance indicators, defining success metrics, and understanding your organization's data maturity level. Having clear requirements prevents vendors from steering conversations toward

their strengths rather than your needs and ensures you can objectively compare solutions.

- **Ensure comprehensive unification capabilities:** A fundamental requirement for any modern data platform is the ability to consolidate data from multiple sources without creating additional silos. Prioritize platforms that query across data sources without requiring movement or replication, reducing costs while ensuring current information access. The platform should support structured, semistructured, and unstructured data types with integrated solutions for databases, warehouses, and lakes. Equally critical is a unified data intelligence and governance layer providing automated lineage tracking, centralized metadata management, and unified access controls across the entire data landscape. This governance framework enables real-time quality monitoring, compliance oversight, and cross-functional discovery capabilities, dramatically increasing operational efficiency while maintaining data consistency and reliability.
- **Test interoperability and future-proofing capabilities:** Verify that the platform provides open APIs and supports industry standard data formats to prevent vendor lock-in. Look for platforms built on cloud-native, modular architectures that can adapt to changing technology landscapes and support hybrid or multicloud deployments. Examine the vendor's partner ecosystem and prebuilt integrations with your existing technology stack, as strong ecosystem support can significantly reduce implementation complexity. Consider how well the platform integrates with your existing business intelligence (BI) tools, analytics software, and operational systems. The ability to maintain flexibility and avoid proprietary constraints becomes increasingly important as your data strategy evolves.
- **Assess scalability and performance under real-world conditions:** Examine how platforms handle growth in data volume, user load, and processing complexity. Distinguish between vertical scaling (adding more power to existing systems) and horizontal scaling (adding more systems), understanding which approach aligns better with your anticipated growth patterns. During vendor demonstrations, request performance testing with your actual data volumes and user concurrency levels rather than accepting generic benchmarks. Consider the trade-offs between consistency, availability, and partition tolerance to ensure the platform matches your specific operational requirements.
- **Prioritize total cost of ownership (TCO):** Many organizations make the critical mistake of focusing primarily on up-front licensing costs when evaluating data platforms. The true cost extends far beyond initial fees and includes infrastructure expenses, implementation resources, ongoing maintenance, personnel training, and potential scaling costs. When calculating TCO, consider

factors such as the underlying technology stack, disaster recovery processes, change management requirements, and whether the vendor offers self-service capabilities that reduce your need for specialized IT resources. Organizations that thoroughly evaluate TCO often discover that seemingly expensive platforms deliver better long-term value through reduced operational overhead and improved efficiency.

VENDOR SUMMARY PROFILES

This section briefly explains IDC's key observations resulting in a vendor's position in the IDC MarketScape. While every vendor is evaluated against each of the criteria outlined in the Appendix, the description here provides a summary of each vendor's strengths and challenges.

Cloudera

After a thorough evaluation of Cloudera's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Cloudera is a private, Santa Clara–based company, founded in 2008, specializing in hybrid data management and analytics solutions for large enterprises. The Cloudera platform is designed to unify data, analytics, and AI across any cloud or on-premises environment, providing a single platform for managing, securing, and analyzing massive volumes of structured and unstructured data. With a global customer base exceeding 2,000 organizations, Cloudera manages over 25EB of high-value business data and delivers solutions that support modern data architectures, real-time analytics, and enterprise AI initiatives.

Cloudera positions itself as a true hybrid data platform, enabling organizations to manage all their data regardless of location or format as a single, cohesive data estate. The platform's architecture supports seamless workload mobility between on-premises and public clouds (e.g., AWS, Azure, Google Cloud), eliminating the need for refactoring or rewriting. Key features include an open data lakehouse with Apache Iceberg support, robust data governance and lineage, integrated enterprise AI and machine learning (ML) tools, and real-time data streaming and processing capabilities. Cloudera's approach emphasizes openness, flexibility, and enterprise-grade security, catering to organizations with complex, regulated, or large-scale data requirements.

Strengths

- **True hybrid architecture:** Cloudera's platform is architected to deliver interoperability across on-premises datacenters and all major public clouds

without requiring organizations to refactor workloads or rewrite applications. This architectural model enables customers to manage their entire data estate as a single, unified environment, regardless of where data physically resides or what format it takes. By eliminating vendor lock-in and supporting a broad range of compute engines and storage formats, Cloudera empowers enterprises to optimize for cost, performance, and governance without compromising on technology choice or operational control. This true hybrid capability significantly reduces migration complexity and cost, future proofs data architectures, and supports both legacy modernization and rapid innovation initiatives.

- **Integrated enterprise AI and real-time analytics:** Cloudera offers built-in AI and machine learning capabilities, including collaborative workbenches, model life-cycle management, and support for major ML frameworks. The platform also delivers advanced real-time analytics and streaming data processing, with low-latency event processing and edge data management for IoT use cases. The platform's AI capabilities are enhanced through strategic acquisitions such as Verta for operational AI management and partnerships with leading AI providers such as NVIDIA, Anthropic, and CrewAI. For real-time use cases, Cloudera's streaming architecture can process millions of events per second with sub-second latency, enabling time-sensitive applications like fraud detection, network optimization, and predictive maintenance.
- **Deep data governance and lineage capabilities:** Cloudera's platform offers robust, enterprise-grade data governance and lineage features that are tightly integrated across its hybrid and multicloud environments. Through its Shared Data Experience (SDX), the platform provides unified metadata management, automated lineage tracking, and comprehensive security controls, ensuring consistent policy enforcement and auditability regardless of where data resides or how it is accessed. The acquisition of Octopai extended these capabilities by enabling cross-platform lineage, including the ability to recover lost metadata and visualize data movement both inside and outside of Cloudera's environments.

Challenges

- **Perceived legacy positioning:** Cloudera's extensive history in the data management market, dating back to its founding in 2008, can sometimes result in a perception among prospective customers that the platform is less innovative. This perceived legacy positioning is influenced by Cloudera's roots in on-premises big data solutions and its evolution through significant industry shifts, including its merger with Hortonworks and transition to a hybrid-first strategy. While Cloudera has invested heavily in modernizing its platform, such as integrating support for open data lakehouse architectures, AI/ML capabilities, and multicloud operations, some buyers may still associate the brand with legacy

Hadoop-based deployments or view its broad, enterprise-focused feature set as complex and slower to adopt the latest innovations.

- **Resource-intensive implementation and integration:** While Cloudera's hybrid-first approach and comprehensive capabilities appeal to large enterprises, smaller organizations or those with limited technical resources may find the initial setup and configuration to be resource intensive. In addition, the need to balance enterprise-grade stability and security with the adoption of the latest open source innovations can introduce a slight lag in delivering the very newest features, which some customers may perceive as a disadvantage. As organizations seek to connect Cloudera with a diverse set of third-party tools, cloud services, and on-premises systems, initial setup and ongoing interoperability efforts may require significant planning, specialized expertise, and dedicated resources.

Consider Cloudera When

Consider Cloudera when your organization requires a true hybrid data platform that can seamlessly manage data across on premises, multiple clouds, and edge environments without sacrificing governance or flexibility. For multinational corporations and highly regulated industries, Cloudera is particularly advantageous, as it allows for strict data locality and compliance requirements to be met while providing the flexibility to shift workloads between environments as business needs evolve. Cloudera is particularly well suited for large enterprises in regulated industries such as financial services, telecommunications, and the public sector, where unified data management, robust security, and compliance are paramount. The platform is designed for data engineers, architects, and analytics leaders who need to integrate diverse data types and leverage both real-time and batch analytics. Its ability to support a wide range of data workloads, including predictive maintenance, risk analysis, data-in-motion use cases, and cybersecurity, makes it a strong choice for organizations modernizing complex data estates and driving enterprise AI initiatives.

Databricks

After a thorough evaluation of Databricks' strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Leaders category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Databricks, founded in 2013 and headquartered in San Francisco, offers the Databricks Data Intelligence Platform, a unified environment designed to enable organizations to leverage data and AI at scale. Built on a lakehouse architecture, the platform combines the flexibility of data lakes with the governance and performance of data warehouses. It integrates storage, processing, governance, and AI/ML capabilities into a single, open,

and cloud-agnostic solution. Databricks serves a global customer base across more than 130 countries, with a strong presence across a wide variety of industries.

The Databricks Data Intelligence Platform is positioned as an open, unified solution for all data and AI workloads. Its architecture is centered around open table formats, with Unity Catalog providing centralized governance and metadata management across both structured and unstructured data. The platform supports a wide range of data engineering, data warehousing, business intelligence, machine learning, and generative AI use cases. Databricks differentiates itself through its use of AI to optimize performance, automate data management tasks, and enable natural language interaction with organizational data. The platform is available on AWS, Azure, Google, and Alibaba clouds, offering both multitenant and single-tenant software-as-a-service (SaaS) options. Databricks emphasizes strong integration with partner ecosystems and provides extensive developer and partner enablement programs.

Strengths

- **Expansive depth of capabilities and seamlessly integrated:** The Databricks Data Intelligence Platform supports data lake, warehouse, and lakehouse architectures, leveraging open formats such as Delta Lake and Apache Iceberg for flexibility. It features advanced data ingestion, integration, and automated schema evolution, with native connectors to databases, SaaS apps, and streaming sources. Lakeflow enables declarative pipeline creation, automated scaling, and real-time analytics. The platform also provides agentic AI and machine learning tools through Mosaic AI, supporting a wide range of data and AI use cases while simplifying operations. Unity Catalog provides the governance and metadata management layer that centralizes access controls, lineage, and data discovery across all data and AI assets within organizations to manage security, compliance, and collaboration across environments. Databricks SQL is used by over 60% of the Fortune 500 companies because it is open and unified and drives a low total cost of ownership. The platform is designed to integrate seamlessly at any layer of the data and AI stack, serving as a unified foundation or modular component for storage, governance, data engineering, analytics, and AI workloads.
- **AI-driven approach:** A broad range of AI features are embedded throughout the Databricks Data Intelligence Platform to optimize performance, simplify user interactions, and accelerate the development of data and AI solutions. The platform leverages advanced AI and machine learning models to automate query optimization, resource allocation, and table maintenance, such as predictive scheduling of operations based on actual usage patterns. Databricks also enables natural language access to data, allowing users to receive recommendations for data exploration and converse with their data using

terminology specific to their organization, thus facilitating data discovery and dashboard creation without technical expertise. AI-powered assistants and agents such as Databricks Assistant and AI/BI Genie help users write, explain, and optimize queries; generate dashboards; explore data; and automate complex data engineering or analytics workflows.

- **Ample partner ecosystem:** Databricks maintains a global partner ecosystem of over 10,000 organizations, including leading cloud providers such as Microsoft (with Azure Databricks as a first-party service), AWS, and Google. The company supports more than 1,500 technology partners and 3,700 implementation partners and has expanded into the SAP ecosystem with SAP Databricks. Databricks invests in partner enablement through its Partner Academy, while Databricks Marketplace and Partner Connect provide access to pre-integrated solutions. Partnerships with firms such as Google Cloud, AWS, Microsoft Azure, Anthropic, Palantir, and Meta further enhance AI and data collaboration capabilities.

Challenges

- **Market perception in data warehousing and BI:** While Databricks has made significant investments in its data warehousing and business intelligence capabilities, it faces ongoing challenges related to market perception in this segment. As a new entrant, Databricks must continually educate customers about the maturity and completeness of its data warehousing and BI solutions, such as Databricks SQL and Databricks AI/BI. Databricks is still viewed primarily as a very technical platform for data engineering and machine learning rather than as a comprehensive solution for traditional BI workloads. Overcoming these perceptions and messaging requires ongoing investment in market awareness, customer success stories, and continued innovation in product capabilities for business users to build trust and credibility in the data warehousing and BI markets.
- **Cloud-only limitation:** The Databricks Data Intelligence Platform is designed and optimized for cloud environments, offering deployment options in public and private clouds, but it does not provide a native, customer-managed on-premises solution or hybrid cloud offering. Databricks is focused on organizations with cloud migrations planned or those already with cloud infrastructure in place. Organizations with strict data residency, regulatory, or security requirements that mandate on-premises data processing and storage, as well as those with significant investments in existing infrastructure, may find migration to a cloud-only platform to be a complex, costly, or misaligned solution for their IT strategies. Industries such as government, defense, and certain segments of financial services often require on-premises solutions to meet

compliance or operational policies, and the lack of this option may exclude Databricks from consideration in these scenarios.

Consider Databricks When

Consider Databricks when you need an open, unified data and AI platform that deeply understands your organization's unique data semantics. This solution is ideal for data-driven enterprises implementing end-to-end analytics and AI initiatives from data engineering to production ML/AI deployments, with requirements for collaborative environments among data engineers, scientists, and business analysts. Data scientists and engineers benefit from Databricks' ability to support all data and AI use cases with a single governance model and integration with software engineering best practices. The platform's data intelligence capabilities enable natural language access tailored to your organization's terminology, making data accessible to everyone while maintaining governance. Databricks' strengths in open data formats, integrated governance via Unity Catalog, and AI-powered data processes make it an optimal choice for organizations seeking to modernize their data landscape and accelerate their AI workflows.

Google

After a thorough evaluation of Google's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Leaders category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

BigQuery is Google Cloud's flagship data to AI platform, designed to unify analytics, governance, AI, and business intelligence across multimodal data. Built on Google's scalable, high-performance infrastructure, BigQuery delivers a serverless, fully managed experience that supports near-infinite scale and open, cross-cloud flexibility. The platform integrates deeply with Google Cloud's broader portfolio, including Vertex AI, Looker, Dataflow, Dataplex Universal Catalog, AlloyDB, Spanner, and BigLake. Google's broad ecosystem enables organizations to activate AI, accelerate decision-making, and drive business outcomes from a single, AI-native environment.

BigQuery is positioned as an autonomous data-to-AI platform, emphasizing three core pillars: unification, AI-native integration, and flexibility. The platform provides a cohesive workspace with BigQuery Studio for data analysts, engineers, and scientists. BigQuery's architecture enables customers to analyze structured, semistructured, and unstructured data within a single environment. The platform's AI capabilities are deeply embedded, offering integrated machine learning in BigQuery ML, vector search, and generative AI via Gemini for advanced analytics and application development. BigQuery's open approach supports multiple data formats and its cross-cloud capabilities in BigQuery Omni allow analytics across Google Cloud, AWS, and Azure

without data movement. In addition, unified governance is embedded into the product, powered by Dataplex, to provide end-to-end lineage, data quality, security, and compliance across the data life cycle.

Strengths

- **Collaboration across personas:** Google BigQuery has a highly collaborative and unified user experience, designed to maximize productivity across diverse data teams. BigQuery Studio serves as a single workspace where data analysts, data scientists, and data engineers can work together using SQL, Python, Spark, and even natural language interfaces. This collaborative environment is enhanced by integrated version control with Git, AI-powered chat and code assistance, and seamless transitions between code-based and visual workflows. The platform's design encourages best practices from software development, such as versioning and collaborative editing, and extends these to data and analytics workflows, helping organizations accelerate time to insight and foster cross-functional teamwork at scale.
- **Integrated AI/ML and agentic capabilities:** BigQuery's AI and ML capabilities are embedded throughout the platform, enabling users to perform predictive analytics, vector search, large language model (LLM) inference, and retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) directly on governed data. The platform provides deep API-level integration with Vertex AI and AlloyDB for model training, fine-tuning, and inference, as well as native support for pretrained and open source models. In addition, Google offers data agents built into the platform to assist with data preparation, engineering, and governance tasks, thus democratizing AI and boosting productivity. Gemini-powered features automate code generation, data preparation, and migration, with strong adoption and customer satisfaction metrics. Notably, BigQuery also supports real-time analytics and continuous SQL processing, allowing organizations to deploy AI-driven, business-critical use cases such as fraud detection or personalized recommendations on streaming data without the need for complex external pipelines.
- **Enterprise-grade scalability, availability, and disaster recovery:** BigQuery is architected on Google's globally distributed, highly resilient infrastructure, ensuring that both compute and storage resources scale independently and automatically to accommodate fluctuating workloads without manual intervention. The platform's managed disaster recovery features include cross-region data set replication and near-real-time continuous data replication, providing robust business continuity and rapid failover. High availability is inherent, with data synchronously replicated across multiple zones within a region and automated failover mechanisms for both storage and compute. Advanced workload management capabilities, such as reservations, autoscaling,

and idle slot sharing, allow organizations to optimize resource allocation and control costs. Customers benefit from predictable, flexible pricing models, and a robust FinOps toolkit for cost management.

Challenges

- **Sensitivity to hyperscaler lock-in:** Despite BigQuery's open architecture, support for open formats and plans to extend catalog federation enabling read/write to external Iceberg tables, some customers have a perception about potential vendor lock-in. Google uniquely offers BigQuery Omni that lets users run BigQuery analytics on data stored in Amazon S3 or Azure Blob Storage. This caution is heightened in highly regulated or global enterprises that require consistent governance and data residency across multiple environments. Enterprises pursuing multicloud strategies may delay adoption until they are fully confident in the platform's portability and flexibility across cloud environments.
- **Unstructured data dependencies:** While BigQuery supports multimodal data and enables users to represent unstructured assets such as images, audio, and documents as object tables, its full unstructured data capabilities depend on storing data in Google Cloud Storage. Users can leverage BigQuery ML to run inference on image object tables with popular frameworks and can extend analytics using remote functions. However, advanced processing or domain-specific analysis often requires integrating with additional Google Cloud services, such as Cloud Vision or Vertex AI, which may add complexity for organizations seeking a fully unified experience. This can introduce extra configuration and operational steps, particularly for teams with extensive or specialized unstructured data needs.

Consider Google When

Consider Google's BigQuery when you need a serverless, highly scalable data platform with seamless AI integration and minimal operational overhead. This solution is ideal for data scientists, data stewards, data engineers, and data analysts who require automatic scaling of both compute and storage resources without manual intervention. Organizations with massive data sets benefit from BigQuery's ability to handle petabyte-scale analytics while automatically transitioning data to lower-cost long-term storage after 90 days. The platform caters to organizations already invested in the Google ecosystem with deep integration of other products such as Vertex AI and Looker. Google's BigQuery is a cloud-native, fully managed analytics platform that unifies data, governance, AI, and analytics at a massive scale. BigQuery's strengths in real-time analytics, automated data quality, and cross-cloud capabilities make it ideal for organizations prioritizing agility, innovation in generative AI solutions, and advanced analytics.

HPE

After a thorough evaluation of HPE's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Contenders category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

The HPE Data Fabric software is a unified data platform offered by Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) designed to address the challenges of managing, integrating, and analyzing data across hybrid, multicloud, and edge environments. The platform consolidates a variety of data sources and real-time/batch streams into a single logical data plane, accessible through a global namespace. It is positioned as an intelligent data lakehouse, enabling organizations to simplify data management, enforce governance, and accelerate analytics and AI initiatives at scale. HPE Data Fabric is deployed globally, serving a diverse customer base across industries such as financial services, the public sector, retail, and manufacturing.

HPE Data Fabric is engineered to provide seamless data unification, accessibility, and management across on-premises, cloud, and edge locations. Its core capabilities include multiprotocol data access, automated storage tiering, and robust data life-cycle management. The platform supports both structured and unstructured data, offering schema-on-read flexibility and integration with a wide range of open source analytics and AI/ML tools. HPE Data Fabric's global namespace and federation features allow organizations to manage and access distributed data sources without duplication and data movement. Its architecture emphasizes scalability, high availability, and enterprise-grade security, with features such as policy-based encryption, geofencing, end-to-end auditing, RBAC, and compliance certifications. The solution is available as software-defined, supporting deployment across major public clouds, private clouds, on-premises, and hybrid models, with container-native options via Kubernetes CSI drivers.

Strengths

- **Unified global namespace and multiprotocol support:** HPE Data Fabric delivers a hybrid data plane that unifies files, objects, NoSQL databases, and both real-time and batch streams into a single logical data store, accessible through a global namespace spanning on-premises, edge, and multicloud environments. The platform supports a wide range of data formats, including CSV, JSON, Parquet, AVRO, ORC, XML, XLSX, text documents, images, audio, video, and Kafka-compatible event streams. This enables organizations to consolidate structured, semistructured, and unstructured data sources. Seamless access is provided via standard APIs and protocols such as S3, NFS, POSIX, HDFS, Iceberg, and Kafka, with built-in federation capabilities for external S3 and NFS sources.

This eliminates data silos and simplifies integration for organizations with complex, distributed data landscapes.

- **Integrated ecosystem for analytics and AI/ML workloads:** HPE Data Fabric provides a robust and developer-friendly environment that supports and maintains a wide array of open source and enterprise analytics tools, including Apache Spark, Airflow, Flink, Presto, and MLflow, all of which can be deployed on bare metal or within containerized environments. This flexibility empowers organizations to construct comprehensive analytics and AI/ML pipelines, integrating both real-time and batch data processing. The platform offers native support for Helm charts and Kubernetes-native orchestration, streamlining deployment and management for DevOps teams. Developers benefit from extensive APIs, SDKs, and a dedicated developer portal featuring documentation, code samples, and community resources that accelerates workflow automation and integration efforts.
- **Deployment and pricing flexibility:** HPE Data Fabric offers extensive deployment flexibility, supporting multitenant and single-tenant as-a-service options across public and private clouds, on-premises, and hybrid environments, with compatibility for AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, and HPE GreenLake. The platform's pricing model is equally adaptable, allowing customers the flexibility to choose from subscription, perpetual, or term-based licensing, with capacity-based metrics such as CPU, GPU, and storage tiers. This flexibility enables organizations to align deployment and costs with their specific operational needs, manage sporadic or bursty workloads efficiently, and benefit from volume discounts for large-scale or long-term commitments.

Challenges

- **User experience and technical expertise:** While HPE Data Fabric has made strides in user interface (UI) simplification, some of the advanced configurations might require technical expertise. HPE's platform relies on third-party integrations for tasks such as hyperparameter tuning or data quality checks. Critical AI/ML features such as automated data profiling, natural language search for data and analytical assets, and prebuilt AI models are either road map items or dependent on partner tools, which may require organizations to invest in custom development.
- **Limited out-of-the-box data quality and cataloging features:** Data quality scoring and advanced cataloging are not natively provided. Customers typically rely on third-party tools or build custom solutions for these needs. While Hive Metastore is currently used for cataloging, advanced features such as internetlike and natural language search are either road map items or supported through

partner integrations. HPE has plans for improvements in this area on the road map, and it will be available in the future software releases.

Consider HPE When

Consider the HPE Data Fabric software when your organization is seeking a hybrid data lakehouse solution that unifies files, objects, NoSQL databases, and real-time streams. This solution is ideal for organizations managing data across on-premises, edge, and multicloud environments that require seamless access through a global namespace. Data architects and engineers benefit from HPE Data Fabric's ability to eliminate manual data integration and reduce latency while providing a single access plane for enterprisewide data lakehouse operations. Technical teams with expertise in open source data tools and hybrid infrastructure will benefit most from the platform's flexibility and depth. The platform's seamless scalability to handle exabyte-scale data while maintaining enterprise-grade security and compliance makes it particularly valuable platform for organizations with disconnected or edge-to-core use cases that require consistent data access regardless of location.

IBM

After a thorough evaluation of IBM's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

IBM's watsonx.data is an open, hybrid data lakehouse platform designed to unify, curate, and analyze both structured and unstructured data for enterprise-scale AI and analytics initiatives. The solution leverages a multiengine architecture to optimize for both price and performance; supports deployment across public cloud, private cloud, hybrid, and on-premises environments; and is tightly integrated with IBM's broader data and AI ecosystem. IBM's watsonx.data is positioned as a foundational platform for organizations seeking to operationalize AI, automate data governance, and accelerate insight generation from diverse data assets.

IBM positions watsonx.data as a comprehensive platform for enterprises aiming to harness the full value of their data, particularly in support of generative AI and advanced analytics. Key features include seamless integration with existing data lakes and warehouses, support for open formats such as Apache Iceberg, and a unified semantic layer that enables AI-powered data discovery and governance. The platform's architecture separates storage and compute, allowing organizations to scale resources efficiently. IBM's watsonx.data is further differentiated by its robust AI and machine learning capabilities, including automated governance, anomaly detection, and real-time analytics, all accessible through no-code, low-code, and pro-code interfaces. IBM's

focus on hybrid and multicloud flexibility ensures that organizations can manage sensitive data securely while leveraging scalability and elasticity.

Strengths

- **AI-ready data management:** IBM's watsonx.data provides an integrated, automated approach to preparing unstructured data for AI, addressing a key barrier for organizations seeking to operationalize generative AI at scale. The platform streamlines the ingestion, enrichment, and governance of unstructured data, supported by robust pipelines and semantic enrichment tools, enabling organizations to unlock value from documents, images, and other nontabular sources. With a built-in vector database, Milvus, and the recent addition of DataStax, watsonx.data supports advanced RAG workflows, and IBM's internal testing indicates up to a 40% improvement in RAG accuracy over traditional vector-only approaches. These capabilities are accessible through a unified experience, with end-to-end user access controls and integration with IBM's governance suite, enabling consistent, secure, and scalable AI model training and deployment across hybrid environments.
- **Advanced governance and data intelligence:** With the recent launch of watsonx.data intelligence, watsonx.data incorporates built-in governance that is compatible with existing solutions, including IBM Knowledge Catalog, Data Product Hub, and Manta Data Lineage, providing enterprise compliance and security. The platform features semantic enrichment capabilities that automatically generate meaningful column names and descriptions with context, ultimately accelerating data curation through increased accuracy and precision of auto term assignments using AI and LLMs. In addition, integration with IBM's Data Product Hub streamlines data sharing, enabling the creation, governance, and life-cycle management of high-quality data products with seamless self-service discovery and access. This comprehensive governance framework ensures that data products are shared and used in a compliant manner across all use cases.
- **Mainframe data integration with data gate:** IBM's watsonx.data uniquely addresses enterprise mainframe data challenges through IBM's integrated Data Gate for watsonx technology, which synchronizes transactional data from IBM Z sources, including Db2 for z/OS, IMS, and VSAM into open Iceberg format. This purpose-built synchronization technology reduces mainframe CPU usage compared with traditional replication methods while maintaining high zIIP eligibility. The solution delivers ultralow latency and high throughput capabilities. Data Gate enables organizations to unlock decades of valuable transactional data for AI and analytics without impacting production mainframe systems. This

capability opens new possibilities for leveraging mission-critical business data in modern analytics and AI applications.

Challenges

- **Market penetration and platform maturity:** IBM's watsonx.data faces challenges in establishing broad market penetration due to its relatively recent entry into the competitive data lakehouse market. watsonx.data's complex architecture and steep learning curve create adoption barriers, particularly for organizations new to IBM's ecosystem. In addition, the platform is still maturing, as IBM is actively bringing together previously distinct products into a more unified experience. For example, watsonx.data integration and watsonx.data intelligence have only recently become generally available as part of the watsonx.data product suite. This ongoing consolidation may introduce transitional complexity for customers seeking a fully cohesive and stable solution in the near term.
- **Learning curve and complexity:** Organizations may encounter a steep learning curve that particularly impacts nontechnical teams and users unfamiliar with IBM's ecosystem, creating enterprisewide deployment challenges. IBM is continuing to advance AI assistant and agentic capabilities for less technical users, but there is still progress to be done here. The platform's inherent complexity becomes most pronounced during initial setup and configuration phases, where organizations without extensive big data expertise struggle to achieve successful implementations. These challenges are amplified by performance limitations when managing multiple large user groups. In addition, while watsonx.data supports numerous data sources, organizations encounter substantial integration difficulties with legacy systems and proprietary databases that don't conform to standard protocols, often requiring customization efforts.

Consider IBM When

Consider IBM's watsonx.data when your organization is seeking an open lakehouse platform that prioritizes unstructured data for AI and analytics across hybrid and multicloud environments. Financial institutions, healthcare providers, and government agencies with strict compliance requirements will appreciate its advanced security capabilities and integration with IBM's watsonx.ai foundation models for enriching and transforming data using AI-driven recommendations. Enterprises with significant investments in legacy systems, such as mainframes, or those looking to modernize their data lakes and optimize data warehouse costs, will find watsonx.data's hybrid, open architecture, and workload-optimized engines advantageous for integrating and operationalizing trusted data at scale. While the product is better aligned with the needs of large and complex organizations, watsonx.data can also support midmarket companies with advanced data integration, governance, and AI ambitions.

InterSystems

After a thorough evaluation of InterSystem's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

InterSystems is a privately held data technology company headquartered in Boston, Massachusetts, with a global presence spanning over 80 countries and with more than 2,000 employees. Founded in 1978, the company has firmly established itself in data management, integration, and analytics, particularly within the healthcare, financial services, and supply chain sectors. Its flagship product, InterSystems IRIS, is a comprehensive, cloud-first data platform designed to unify transactional and analytical workloads, support multimodel data management, and enable real-time, AI-powered applications. With a focus on delivering high performance, reliability, and interoperability, InterSystems serves over 1,000 enterprise customers and maintains a robust partner ecosystem to support diverse deployment and integration needs.

InterSystems IRIS is positioned as a unified data platform that addresses the complexity of modern data environments by integrating transactional and analytical processing within a single architecture. The platform's core innovation lies in its "common data plane," which enables multimodel data representation without data duplication. This architecture allows organizations to process, analyze, and operationalize data in real time, reducing latency and infrastructure costs. IRIS is further distinguished by embedded interoperability and orchestration capabilities, support for embedded AI/ML (including integrated vector search and GenAI features), and flexible deployment options across public, private, hybrid, and multicloud environments. The platform is complemented by industry-specific modules, low-code/no-code tools such as Data Fabric Studio, and prebuilt solutions for healthcare, financial services, and supply chain management.

Strengths

- **Integrated multimodel and multi-workload architecture:** InterSystems IRIS offers a single, unified platform that supports a broad spectrum of data models and workload types (e.g., transactional, analytical, and streaming) without requiring multiple engines or data duplication. This design simplifies architecture, reduces operational complexity, and enables consistent governance and security across all data assets. The platform's core abstraction allows for seamless representation and access to relational, document, object, key value, vector, and time series data, all within the same environment. By enabling transparent projections between data models and supporting both schema on read and schema on write, IRIS empowers organizations to efficiently ingest, store, and analyze diverse data types and sources at high speed and scale while

minimizing storage overhead and eliminating the need for complex ETL processes.

- **High performance and scalability for real-time use cases:** The platform is engineered for high throughput and low-latency processing, demonstrated by large-scale deployments managing billions of transactions per day and supporting mission-critical applications in healthcare and financial services. The "bring processing to the data" approach, combined with advanced caching and elasticity features, allows IRIS to deliver strong price/performance and reliability at scale. InterSystems IRIS leverages a fully transparent, cloud-scalable, and coherent cache and elastic architecture that enables seamless horizontal and vertical scaling, supporting both operational and analytical workloads even in highly distributed, hybrid, or multicloud environments.
- **Developer-friendly platform:** InterSystems IRIS is recognized for its strong developer orientation, offering a comprehensive suite of tools and experiences that cater to both professional developers and data engineers. The platform provides robust support for multiple programming languages, including Python, Java, C#, Go, and InterSystems' ObjectScript, enabling developers to work in their language of choice and leverage familiar development environments such as Visual Studio Code and open source SQL tools. InterSystems IRIS features extensive APIs, SDKs, and a rich set of client libraries, alongside integrated developer tooling for source control, debugging, and workflow automation. The platform also fosters a vibrant developer community through training programs, hackathons, and open source contributions, ensuring that developers have access to resources, best practices, and a collaborative ecosystem that accelerates solution development and innovation.

Challenges

- **Limited reach to nontechnical business users:** While InterSystems IRIS has introduced enhancements aimed at improving accessibility for nontechnical business users, such as low-code interfaces, drag-and-drop tools, and natural language querying in other products such as Data Fabric Studio, the platform's core experience remains more developer and data engineer centric. Many advanced features and workflows still require technical proficiency or familiarity with programming concepts, which can present a barrier for business analysts and other nontechnical stakeholders seeking to leverage data independently. Although ongoing road map investments target user experience improvements, further progress is needed to deliver truly intuitive, self-service capabilities that empower a broader range of business users to create, analyze, and operationalize data products without heavy reliance on IT or data engineering teams.

- **Brand recognition outside healthcare:** While InterSystems is highly regarded within healthcare and has strong references in financial services and supply chain, its brand awareness is comparatively lower in broader horizontal data management markets. This can impact initial consideration in competitive evaluations, especially outside its core verticals. As a result, potential customers in other industries may be less familiar with InterSystems' capabilities, requiring additional education and outreach to establish credibility and differentiation.

Consider InterSystems When

Consider InterSystems IRIS if your organization requires a high-performance, cloud-first data platform that excels in real-time transactional and analytical workloads, particularly in industries such as healthcare, supply chain, and financial services. IRIS is designed for data architects, integration engineers, and application developers who need a unified platform supporting multiple data models, advanced analytics, and integration across disparate systems without moving or copying information. Its ability to deliver low-latency analytics directly on operational data, combined with robust support for interoperability and industry-specific requirements, makes it a compelling choice for organizations building mission-critical, AI-enabled applications that demand speed, reliability, and scalability.

Microsoft

After a thorough evaluation of Microsoft's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Microsoft Fabric is a unified, cloud-based data analytics platform that consolidates data integration, engineering, warehousing, science, real-time analytics, and business intelligence into a single software-as-a-service environment. Built on top of Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse Analytics, and Power BI, Fabric provides a modern, open, and lake-centric architecture centered around OneLake, a multicloud data lake. The platform is designed to simplify data management and analytics workflows, offering role-specific experiences for technical and business users and embedding AI-driven features to accelerate data-driven decision-making across organizations.

Microsoft positions Fabric as an end-to-end data and analytics solution that eliminates the need for fragmented data tools and complex integrations. The platform offers a cohesive set of workloads, including Data Factory, Data Engineering, Data Warehouse, Data Science, Databases, Real-Time Intelligence, and Power BI, each tailored for different user personas. Fabric's architecture is lake centric and open, supporting Delta Lake formats and integration with external storage. Called OneLake, it serves as the unified storage layer, enabling centralized data discovery, governance, and sharing. The

platform also leverages Azure AI Foundry and Copilot to embed AI and automation throughout the analytics life cycle and integrates natively with Microsoft 365 to enhance collaboration and productivity.

Strengths

- **Comprehensive data integration capabilities:** The platform supports seamless connectivity to over 170 data sources, including databases, cloud storage, on-premises systems, and real-time streaming data, enabling organizations to consolidate diverse data assets efficiently. Fabric's integrated Data Factory provides both no-code and advanced ETL tools, allowing users to orchestrate complex data workflows, automate data movement, and apply intelligent transformations with ease. Fabric offers modern monitoring and orchestration features, including cross-workspace pipeline management, event-driven triggers, and integration with Microsoft 365 for automated notifications, enabling organizations to efficiently oversee and optimize data workflows at scale. With features such as fast data copying, real-time event routing, and support for both structured and unstructured data, Fabric simplifies the integration process and reduces reliance on multiple third-party tools.
- **Embedded AI and role-specific experiences:** Microsoft Fabric advances analytics democratization by deeply embedding AI capabilities, notably Copilot, across all workloads. This integration enables users to interact with data using natural language, generate SQL queries, create data transformations, and receive intelligent suggestions without advanced technical skills. Fabric delivers tailored, role-specific experiences: Data engineers benefit from AI-powered code generation and automation, data scientists receive intelligent model recommendations and automated documentation, and business analysts can access data through conversational interfaces. Combined with Azure AI Foundry, this AI-first approach reduces barriers to advanced analytics and accelerates "time to insight" by providing relevant, context-aware assistance for diverse user roles.
- **Strength of Power BI:** With Power BI being one of the most used business intelligence tools in the market, it often serves as a primary entry point for many organizations to start adopting the broader Microsoft Fabric platform. Power BI's widespread adoption is driven by its user-friendly interface, extensive visualization capabilities, and strong integration with the broader Microsoft stack, making it accessible to business users and data professionals alike. Within Fabric, Power BI acts as the dedicated business intelligence and visualization layer, allowing users to seamlessly access and analyze data stored in OneLake and other Fabric-managed sources. This integration not only streamlines the transition for existing Power BI users but also enables organizations to expand

from departmental reporting to comprehensive, enterprise-grade analytics, leveraging the full capabilities of the Fabric platform as their needs evolve.

Challenges

- **Evolving data intelligence capabilities:** OneLake catalog provides strong foundational capabilities, including data discovery, domain organization, tagging, endorsements, and governance insights. However, some advanced features remain in development — fine-grained access controls across all asset types and comprehensive cross-workspace lineage for non-Power BI items are road mapped. In addition, while Microsoft recently announced data quality monitoring improvements with materialized lake views (June 2025), organizations may still need custom scripts or third-party tools for comprehensive data quality management. OneLake catalog is designed specifically to manage Fabric assets, making it more difficult to manage a metadata layer across the entire data ecosystem. However, Microsoft Purview is a complementary product that offers enterprisewide catalog capabilities that extend beyond Fabric to cover heterogeneous data estates. Organizations should evaluate whether current governance capabilities align with their requirements while considering the platform's maturing features.
- **Product evolution and ecosystem maturity:** As a collection of existing tools, including Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse Analytics, and Power BI, Fabric requires ongoing innovation and development to achieve seamless integration across all workloads. This evolutionary nature means that organizations may encounter inconsistencies in user experience, feature gaps between components, and varying levels of maturity across different platform capabilities. In addition, while Fabric supports open formats and multicloud storage, its deepest integrations and optimizations remain within the Microsoft ecosystem, potentially limiting organizations with highly heterogeneous environments or significant non–Microsoft infrastructure investments. The platform's relatively recent entry into the unified data and analytics space also creates market perception challenges, particularly among organizations with established data toolchains or those accustomed to legacy Microsoft solutions.

Consider Microsoft When

Consider Microsoft Fabric when you need a unified data and analytics platform that seamlessly connects to data without moving or duplicating it. It is particularly relevant for companies with existing investments in Microsoft technologies or those seeking to consolidate disparate Microsoft data tools into a single platform. It is designed for business analysts, data engineers, and IT leaders who value seamless data virtualization, near-real-time data access, and AI-powered self-service analytics. The platform's integration with Microsoft's AI services and ability to easily connect to data

through shortcuts to virtualize data in OneLake makes it particularly valuable for organizations looking to implement AI-driven analytics without complex data movement.

Oracle

After a thorough evaluation of Oracle's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Leaders category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Oracle Autonomous Database is a cloud-native data platform designed to support a wide range of analytic workloads, including data marts, data warehouses, data lakes, and data lakehouses. It leverages automation and machine learning to deliver self-driving, self-securing, and self-repairing database capabilities. The product is positioned as a converged data platform solution, providing integrated support for multiple data models and data types, built-in AI and analytics, and advanced security. Oracle Autonomous Database is available in major public clouds (e.g., OCI, AWS, Azure, Google Cloud) and on premises on Exadata Cloud@Customer and Dedicated Region, supporting multicloud and hybrid deployments. Oracle colocates Oracle Database software and supports Exadata and OCI infrastructure at Azure, AWS, and Google datacenters, allowing customers to connect a fully managed, performant Oracle Database to Azure/AWS/Google apps. Recent data platform innovations include Oracle Database 23ai, AI Vector Search, and JSON Relational Duality Views.

Oracle Autonomous Database is positioned as a comprehensive data platform that addresses the needs of both business and technical users. Its core differentiator is the convergence of multiple data processing and analytics capabilities within a single managed service and the elimination of human errors from the database management process, including automatic threat detection and remediation. The platform integrates self-service analytics, low-code application development, GenAI built-in machine learning, and advanced data security. It is designed to simplify data management by automating routine tasks, such as provisioning, tuning, patching, scaling, and backup. Oracle emphasizes multicloud flexibility, support for open data formats, and seamless integration with Oracle, open source, and third-party tools. The platform is well suited for organizations seeking to modernize their data infrastructure while maintaining high levels of security and compliance. In addition to scaling up to handle the most demanding applications, it also scales down to handle small applications with as few as two ECPUs (elastic CPUs).

Strengths

- **Integrated self-service analytics and low-code app development:** Oracle Autonomous Database features an integrated AI, self-service analytics, and low-

code development environment through its built-in Data Studio. The platform provides an intuitive interface for preparing data, building analytical workflows, and designing dashboards, making it accessible to users with varying technical expertise. For application development, Oracle Autonomous Database includes free access to Oracle APEX with AI Assistant, enabling users to rapidly create and deploy analytic applications using natural language. The platform also supports analytic views, which ensure consistent business metrics and definitions across teams and projects. Seamless integration with business intelligence tools, including Tableau, Microsoft Power BI, and Oracle Analytics Cloud, further extends its analytic capabilities and facilitates collaboration.

- **Extensive built-in AI and machine learning capabilities:** Users can leverage Oracle Machine Learning to perform the entire ML life cycle, including data exploration, preparation, modeling, deployment, and monitoring, without the need to move data outside the platform. The database supports advanced analytics such as graph, spatial, JSON, time series, and vector search, and it incorporates natural language querying for conversational analysis that combines LLMs with internal data using retrieval-augmented generation for better and more contextually relevant results. These capabilities are accessible to both technical and nontechnical users, enabling organizations to operationalize AI and machine learning at scale, drive richer insights, and accelerate the development of data-driven applications. The integration of these advanced analytics tools within a single, managed data platform reduces complexity, enhances security, and streamlines workflows for data scientists, analysts, and business users alike. For developers, Oracle provides free options of Autonomous Database, either in the cloud or offline development.
- **Advanced security and automation:** Oracle Autonomous Database offers comprehensive, always-on security features, including automated patching, encryption at rest and in transit, granular access controls, and integrated data security tools such as Oracle Data Safe. Automated risk assessments, user activity monitoring, and a built-in SQL Firewall help organizations meet regulatory requirements and reduce the risk of data breaches. The platform's automation extends to database management, reducing operational overhead and improving reliability. These advanced security and compliance capabilities are included at no extra cost, providing organizations with a unified approach to protecting sensitive data across multicloud and hybrid environments.

Challenges

- **Slower to complete interoperability:** Oracle Autonomous Database continues to expand its multicloud presence with offerings such as Oracle Database@Azure, Database@Google Cloud, and Database@AWS, enabling deployment across major hyperscalers. However, this multicloud strategy has

only developed in the past year, resulting in lingering perceptions of a proprietary ecosystem and challenges in seamless interoperability. While Oracle supports open formats and federated data catalogs, customers sometimes hesitate over integration flexibility and long-term multicloud strategy. Oracle is actively working on deeper integrations with open standards such as Apache Iceberg and Polaris to enhance compatibility and ease multicloud deployments, signaling a strong commitment to evolving its ecosystem for broader cloud interoperability.

- **In-product agentic maturity:** Oracle Autonomous Database offers a rich set of AI features, including machine learning–powered automation, Select AI for natural language interactions with data, AI assistants to enhance local data tables, and AI Explain to translate SQL queries into natural language, but agentic AI capabilities are still evolving within the core product. While it excels in AI automation and supports AI-driven applications, true agentic AI (where AI systems autonomously set goals and execute multistep decisions) is not fully embedded natively, similar to broader market challenges. However, Oracle has implemented tools in its extended portfolio like Oracle SQLcl MCP Server for agent connectivity and database interaction as well as Oracle AI Agent Studio for agent building. This strategic approach allows customers to build sophisticated AI agents and utilize agents included in the application layer while Oracle continues to advance agentic AI integration natively.

Consider Oracle When

Consider Oracle Autonomous Database when your organization needs an autonomous, cloud-optimized database for AI and analytic workloads that combines high performance, automated administration, and advanced security. This solution is especially well suited for enterprises looking to leverage existing Oracle investments, whether via cloud deployment or its extended product portfolio. Oracle Autonomous Database supports a broad range of personas, from business analysts and data scientists to IT administrators and application developers. Organizations with requirements for advanced and self-service analytics (including AI and machine learning, graph, JSON, and vector search) or a need for integrated data security and governance will find Oracle Autonomous Database a strong fit. Its strengths in automation, multicloud data integration, and built-in security make it a compelling choice for organizations aiming to reduce operational overhead and accelerate AI and data-driven innovation.

SAP

After a thorough evaluation of SAP's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

SAP Datasphere, now positioned as a core component of the newly launched SAP Business Data Cloud (BDC), is a cloud-based data management platform designed to unify, govern, and deliver business-ready data across hybrid and multicloud environments. Built on SAP Business Technology Platform (BTP) and leveraging SAP HANA Cloud, Datasphere integrates data warehousing, data lakehouse, and advanced analytics capabilities into a single solution. The platform is engineered to provide seamless access to both SAP and non-SAP data, preserve business context, and support a broad range of use cases from self-service analytics to AI-driven applications. SAP Datasphere is supported by a global partner ecosystem and is widely adopted across industries such as financial services, manufacturing, and retail.

SAP Datasphere is positioned as an integrated, enterprise-grade data platform that addresses the full spectrum of data management needs, including real-time and batch data integration, transformation, governance, and analytics. Its architecture combines data lakehouse flexibility with the structure and performance of a data warehouse, enabling organizations to harmonize and manage data from disparate sources without replication. Datasphere's extensibility is enhanced through deep partnerships (e.g., with Databricks and Collibra), support for open data formats, and compatibility with leading BI and AI/ML tools. Its SaaS delivery model ensures scalability, security, and continuous innovation, while integration with SAP's broader portfolio enables customers to leverage a unified data and analytics ecosystem.

Note: This evaluation was based on the SAP Datasphere standalone product rather than SAP Business Data Cloud because BDC only became generally available at the end of April 2025. The recent general availability (GA) release excluded it from this IDC MarketScape; however, the launch of BDC was taken into consideration as part of SAP's go-to-market strategy.

Strengths

- **Integrated business data fabric and semantic modeling:** SAP Datasphere's core differentiator is its ability to deliver a unified business data fabric that preserves and exposes business semantics. The platform allows users to define and reuse business terms, metrics, and relationships, supporting consistent and accurate analytics, planning, and AI/ML initiatives. This semantic layer ensures that data retains its meaning across systems and business functions, reducing the risk of misinterpretation. The recent introduction of SAP Business Data Cloud

further strengthens this integration by connecting the enterprise data layer more closely with the applications layer, streamlining the delivery of harmonized, business-ready data products for intelligent applications and analytics across hybrid and multicloud environments.

- **User accessibility and data exploration:** SAP Datasphere offers strong user accessibility through a combination of intuitive, role-based interfaces and self-service tools designed for both technical and nontechnical users. The platform features customizable dashboards and drag-and-drop data modeling, enabling business analysts and data professionals to prepare, visualize, and analyze data without requiring advanced coding skills. Natural language processing capabilities, integrated via SAP Analytics Cloud, allow users to interact with data conversationally, further lowering barriers for business users. Role-based access controls and scoped permissions ensure that users only see relevant data and tools, supporting efficient collaboration across departments while maintaining security and compliance.
- **Strategic evolution of the data platform:** SAP continues to evolve its approach to data management with the launch of Business Data Cloud. Announced in February 2025 and generally available at the end of April, BDC builds on SAP Datasphere to deliver a unified platform that seamlessly combines data integration, governance, and analytics with intelligent applications. By leveraging Datasphere's business data fabric and semantic modeling, BDC enables organizations to access harmonized, business-ready data products across SAP and non-SAP sources without replication or loss of business context. For data engineers, BDC significantly reduces the time spent on complex ETL pipelines and manual data reconciliation, enabling them to focus more on high-value innovation. This integration supports a wide range of use cases, including analytics, planning, and AI/ML while simplifying data management in hybrid and multicloud environments. The result is, accelerated delivery of actionable insights and the ability to power intelligent, context-aware business applications from a single, scalable cloud solution.

Challenges

- **Integration and usability for non-SAP data:** Even though the platform has made strides in supporting integration with a broad array of third-party systems, including cloud storage, relational and NoSQL databases, and streaming platforms, there remains a strong association with SAP-centric technologies and workflows. Many organizations believe that effective use of Datasphere requires familiarity with SAP-specific concepts and tooling, such as ABAP or SAP's semantic modeling approaches, which can raise barriers for teams accustomed to open source or non-SAP ecosystems. This perception is reinforced by the platform's deep integration with SAP applications and its emphasis on preserving

SAP business context, which, while valuable for SAP customers, can create complexity for those seeking to harmonize non-SAP data sources. Although SAP has introduced native connectors, enhanced data virtualization, and partnerships with technology providers such as Databricks and Collibra to improve openness, there are still usability challenges and a learning curve when onboarding non-SAP data or integrating with third-party applications. Nevertheless, the expanding integrations via BDC are intended to ultimately deliver a unified, business-aware data foundation that connects SAP and non-SAP landscapes, enabling more consistent analytics, planning, and AI-driven innovation across the enterprise.

- **Developer and engineering community:** SAP Datasphere continues to face challenges in growing and engaging its developer community, particularly among developers who are not already familiar with SAP technologies. While the platform provides APIs, SDKs, command-line interface, GitHub resources, SAP BTP extensibility, and a dedicated Datasphere community with resources such as meetups, hackathons, and learning journeys, the ecosystem is still primarily tailored to SAP-centric skill sets and workflows. This perception, coupled with the need for specialized knowledge in SAP environments, can limit broader participation from the wider cloud and open source developer communities. However, SAP continues to make significant strides to grow this community with the launch of SAP Databricks and the Cloud Application Programming (CAP) model powered by SAP data products within Business Data Cloud.

Consider SAP When

Consider SAP Datasphere when you need to harmonize data from different sources while preserving business context, especially within SAP-centric environments. This solution is ideal for organizations with significant investments in SAP applications seeking to build a business data fabric that integrates SAP and non-SAP data. Data modelers and business analysts benefit from Datasphere's ability to reuse semantic definitions and associations from SAP applications, expediting access to contextual, relevant business data for faster insights. The platform's integration with SAP Analytics Cloud and SAP Business AI enables organizations to drive AI-powered growth through harmonized data. With its inclusion in the newly launched Business Data Cloud, Datasphere delivers a unified, high-performance platform supporting a wide range of analytics, planning, and AI/ML use cases across the enterprise.

Snowflake

After a thorough evaluation of Snowflake's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Leaders category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Snowflake, founded in 2012 and headquartered in Bozeman, Montana, is a publicly traded company offering the Snowflake AI Data Cloud, a fully managed, cloud-native data and AI platform. The platform is designed to unify data storage, processing, analytics, and AI/ML capabilities in a single, scalable environment. Snowflake's approach emphasizes ease of use, instant scalability, robust governance, and seamless data sharing and collaboration, serving a global customer base across diverse industries, including financial services, retail, and media and entertainment.

Snowflake positions itself as a unified, fully managed data and AI platform designed to simplify and accelerate data-driven innovation. The platform provides a single data foundation that eliminates the need to manage multiple products or disparate architectures. Snowflake supports a broad range of workloads, including analytics, transactional applications, data engineering, AI/ML, and collaboration, all within one environment. Its architecture enables customers to choose their preferred approach between a data warehouse, data lake, lakehouse, or data mesh, without being locked into a single model. Security, governance, and privacy are integrated from the outset, allowing organizations to manage sensitive data and maintain compliance with ease. Snowflake's consumption-based pricing model ensures customers pay only for what they use, with no up-front infrastructure investment. The platform is available across all major public clouds, offers robust cost management features, and integrates built-in AI capabilities through Cortex AI, making advanced analytics accessible to both technical and business users.

Strengths

- **Intuitive UI:** Snowflake's user experience is widely recognized for its simplicity and accessibility, offering an intuitive, unified interface that allows users of varying technical backgrounds to interact with data, build analytics, and leverage AI capabilities efficiently. The platform provides a single, streamlined environment, Snowsight, that consolidates administration, data exploration, transformation, and advanced analytics into a cohesive workflow. Features such as natural language querying, drag-and-drop data discovery, and integrated notebooks make it easy for both technical and business users to derive insights and collaborate. Snowflake's design philosophy emphasizes on minimizing administrative overhead and enabling rapid onboarding, which is consistently cited by customers as a key differentiator and a driver of high user satisfaction.
- **Enterprise-grade security, governance, and multicloud resilience:** Snowflake integrates enterprise-grade security, governance, and privacy controls directly into its core architecture, ensuring unified policy enforcement across structured and unstructured data, applications, and AI models. The platform provides robust business continuity and disaster recovery through seamless replication and failover capabilities across multiple clouds and geographic regions. Features

such as the Horizon Catalog offer centralized governance, sensitive data classification, and comprehensive data discovery, while the Trust Center delivers real-time security posture monitoring and compliance management. Snowflake's approach allows organizations to confidently manage sensitive workloads, maintain regulatory compliance, and operate resiliently in dynamic, multicloud environments, all with minimal administrative overhead.

- **Strong growth in AI strategy:** Snowflake has demonstrated significant momentum in expanding its AI capabilities and strategic direction in the past year. The platform embeds Cortex AI, a fully integrated, native AI service, directly within its core engine, enabling customers to leverage advanced generative AI, large language models, and machine learning features without external infrastructure or complex integrations. This approach democratizes AI by making it accessible to both technical and business users through no-code, SQL, and REST API interfaces, as well as integrated tools such as Cortex Analyst and Cortex Search for natural language interactions with structured and unstructured data. Snowflake's AI strategy is further reinforced by continuous investments in prebuilt AI services, an AI and ML Studio for streamlined model development, and simplified model deployment workflows that support both CPUs and GPUs within the platform.

Challenges

- **Limitations in data intelligence:** While Snowflake provides a centralized Horizon Catalog for governance and discovery, its data cataloging and metadata management capabilities are still evolving relative to the needs of large, complex enterprises. Users can add metadata, track ownership, and visualize lineage, but certain advanced features, such as automated data quality scoring, richer business context, and deeper integration with external cataloging tools, may require additional configuration or rely on partner solutions. As a result, organizations with highly sophisticated metadata management or federated governance requirements, beyond audit logging and security/privacy controls, may encounter limitations in achieving end-to-end visibility and control solely within the native Snowflake environment.
- **Cost management complexity:** While Snowflake's consumption-based pricing model offers flexibility and can reduce up-front infrastructure costs, customers may encounter challenges in managing and forecasting expenses as usage scales. Without careful monitoring and proactive cost controls, organizations can experience unanticipated increases in spending, particularly when leveraging advanced features such as AI services and dynamic workloads. Snowflake provides built-in tools for cost visibility, budgeting, and alerting, but optimizing usage to avoid unnecessary costs requires ongoing attention and may introduce operational overhead for some customers.

Consider Snowflake When

Consider Snowflake when you need a fully managed, cloud-native platform that separates compute from storage while providing enterprise-grade security and governance. This solution is ideal for organizations seeking to eliminate administrative overhead through a platform that "just works" with automated cluster management, maintenance, and zero-downtime upgrades. The platform is designed for business analysts, data engineers, and IT leaders who value ease of use and support Apache Iceberg and robust governance. The platform's cross-cloud and cross-region data-sharing capabilities make it particularly valuable for organizations looking to collaborate securely without moving data. Snowflake's native AI services enable customers to quickly analyze unstructured data and build generative AI applications using fully managed LLMs.

Teradata

After a thorough evaluation of Teradata's strategies and capabilities, IDC has positioned the company in the Major Players category in this 2025 IDC MarketScape for worldwide data platform software.

Teradata, headquartered in San Diego, California, is a public company founded in 1979 and operates globally with a workforce of approximately 5,700 employees. Its flagship product, Teradata Vantage, is a scalable, enterprise-grade data and analytics platform designed to unify data management, advanced analytics, and artificial intelligence/machine learning capabilities across hybrid and multicloud environments. Vantage integrates with a broad portfolio of companion offerings, such as VantageCloud Enterprise, VantageCloud Lake, ClearScape Analytics, and QueryGrid, to deliver comprehensive solutions for large-scale data integration, high-performance querying, and real-time analytics. The platform is widely adopted in industries such as financial services, retail, insurance, manufacturing, and healthcare by organizations seeking to unlock insights from massive and diverse data sets while maintaining robust governance and compliance.

Teradata Vantage is positioned as a unified data platform that addresses the needs of enterprises with complex, large-scale, and mission-critical analytics workloads. The platform supports a wide range of storage architectures while providing native support for open table formats. Vantage's hybrid and multicloud deployment options span AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud, as well as on-premises environments, offering flexibility and avoiding vendor lock-in. The platform emphasizes high performance through its massively parallel processing architecture, advanced workload management, and seamless integration with external data sources. Teradata's open ecosystem, support for modern data engineering practices, and in-database AI/ML capabilities make it

suitable for organizations pursuing digital transformation, AI-driven analytics, and strict regulatory compliance.

Strengths

- **Scalability, performance, and integration:** The platform's distributed architecture allows for the seamless addition of nodes, supports parallel processing, and ensures that performance remains consistent as data and user demands grow. Specialized compute clusters, including both CPU and GPU resources, are tailored to accommodate a range of enterprise tasks, from traditional analytics to advanced machine learning and generative AI use cases. In addition, Teradata's QueryGrid technology provides seamless data federation and cross-platform analytics by enabling direct querying across hybrid, multicloud, and on-premises environments without the need to move or duplicate data. This architecture minimizes latency and data movement, optimizes resource utilization, and supports real-time analytics at scale. Organizations benefit from the ability to integrate disparate data sources, execute high-concurrency workloads, and maintain reliable performance even during peak operational periods.
- **Advanced workload management:** Teradata Vantage delivers advanced workload management through a combination of dynamic resource allocation, real-time prioritization, and intelligent scheduling mechanisms. The platform continuously monitors system health and workload patterns, automatically adjusting compute and memory resources to ensure that mission-critical queries receive the necessary resources without interruption, even during periods of high concurrency or peak demand. This capability is supported by sophisticated workload management tools, such as Active System Management (ASM) and Teradata Workload Management (TASM), which enable organizations to define granular rules and service-level objectives for different workloads. As a result, Vantage can balance complex, long-running analytical processes with ad hoc and tactical requests, preventing resource contention and bottlenecks.
- **Broad analytics suite:** Teradata has greatly advanced its suite of advanced analytics and AI/ML capabilities integrated into its platform, enabling organizations to address complex analytical challenges at scale. The platform provides over 150 in-database analytic functions, supporting a wide range of use cases from descriptive statistics and feature engineering to predictive modeling and time series forecasting, all executed in parallel for high performance. Teradata's ClearScape Analytics framework allows seamless integration with popular open source tools and languages such as Python, R, and SQL, as well as "bring your own model" and "bring your own analytics" workflows, supporting both native and external machine learning models. In addition, Teradata includes

robust data visualization capabilities, offering built-in dashboards, interactive charts, and integration with leading BI tools, which empower users to explore insights visually and collaborate across teams.

Challenges

- **Incomplete native data intelligence:** While Teradata provides strong privacy, security, and governance features, many data intelligence capabilities, such as comprehensive data cataloging, automated lineage tracking, and unified data discovery, are delivered through integrations with external tools such as Google Cloud Data Catalog, Microsoft Purview, AWS Glue, and Alation. This approach may limit the seamlessness and consistency of data intelligence, as organizations are required to configure and maintain multiple systems to achieve end-to-end visibility and control over their data assets. Furthermore, the absence of a fully native, unified data control plane can hinder efforts to standardize data policies, automate compliance, and streamline metadata management across hybrid and multicloud environments.
- **Product awareness and legacy perception:** Teradata continues to face challenges related to limited product awareness and a persistent perception as a legacy data warehouse provider. Many prospective customers are not fully informed about the platform's modern capabilities, such as its cloud-native architecture, advanced AI/ML integration, and support for open data formats. This lack of awareness often results in longer sales cycles and a greater need for customer education, as organizations may initially view Teradata as outdated or less innovative. Overcoming this legacy perception requires significant investment in marketing and education to demonstrate how Teradata has evolved to support contemporary analytics, hybrid cloud deployments, and AI-driven initiatives.

Consider Teradata When

Teradata Vantage is better suited for large enterprises and upper midmarket organizations with complex, high-volume, and mission-critical analytics requirements. Data scientists and analysts benefit from Vantage's ability to harmonize data across touch points while leveraging embedded machine learning capabilities. The platform's QueryGrid technology enables seamless querying across hybrid, multicloud, and on-premises environments by connecting disparate data sources and compute engines, making Teradata optimal for a hybrid data estate. Teradata's strengths in workload management, open ecosystem integration, and cost efficiency make it an attractive option for organizations seeking to harmonize data and optimize analytics investments at scale.

VENDORS TO WATCH

The following list of data platform software vendors did not meet the inclusion criteria for this evaluation but may also be considered by organizations selecting and implementing a data platform solution:

- Actian
- Amazon
- Progress Software
- Starburst

Actian

The Actian Data Platform is a hybrid, multicloud data management solution designed to meet the evolving needs of enterprise organizations seeking to modernize their data infrastructure while maintaining flexibility and control. Initially built around a high-performance, vectorized relational analytics engine, the platform has expanded to encompass a broad suite of data management capabilities, including data integration, data quality, and governance. The platform is available across all major public cloud providers as well as on premises, enabling hybrid environments and regulatory requirements that necessitate data locality. The platform provides connectivity to over 250 data sources, supporting a wide range of enterprise applications and databases, both cloud based and on premises.

The platform's architecture currently separates the data plane from the data control plane, with two products: Actian Data Platform and Actian Data Intelligence Platform. Actian intends to merge these two platform products in its road map, ultimately bettering its support for the entire data life cycle. The Actian Data Intelligence Platform is a new product obtained through the acquisition of Zeenea, a SaaS-based data intelligence solution. This acquisition has enabled Actian to deliver a federated knowledge graph, robust data cataloging, field-level lineage, and a data marketplace experience. The knowledge graph supports domain-specific data management and accelerates data discovery, while the marketplace provides a shop for data interface for internal data product sharing.

These platforms are designed to be data stack agnostic, allowing integration with third-party tools for data quality, observability, and governance, thereby supporting best-of-breed approaches within the enterprise. Despite its strengths, the Actian Data Platform did not meet the product revenue requirements for inclusion in this IDC MarketScape. Nevertheless, Actian's ongoing investments in consolidating data management products, data lakehouse offerings, cloud-native capabilities, data intelligence, and

flexible deployment models position it as a vendor to watch for organizations seeking a comprehensive, interoperable, and enterprise-ready data platform solution.

Amazon

The Amazon SageMaker Unified Studio represents AWS' latest step toward integrating data, analytics, and AI development within a single environment. Since the next generation of SageMaker was released with data lakehouse capabilities in December 2024, and in full general availability in March 2025, the product was excluded from this IDC MarketScape evaluation. The platform brings together AWS' established data processing, analytics, and AI services, including Amazon Redshift, EMR, Athena, Glue, Bedrock, and SageMaker AI, under a unified user interface and governance framework. This consolidation is designed to address customer needs for end-to-end integration, spanning raw data ingestion, ETL, analytics, and advanced AI use cases such as generative AI app development.

The addition of SageMaker Lakehouse introduces an open, secure, and unified data architecture, leveraging Apache Iceberg and Amazon S3 to support zero-ETL integrations across AWS and third-party data sources. S3 Tables offer fully managed Iceberg tables with automated maintenance, enhanced performance, and table-level security. The platform's governance layer, built on AWS DataZone, Lake Formation, and Glue Data Catalog, provides unified controls for data quality, classification, lineage, permissions, and responsible AI guardrails. This ensures that both data and AI assets are discoverable, accessible, and governed within a single catalog. The platform also embeds Amazon Q, a generative AI assistant, throughout the user experience to accelerate data discovery, code generation, and workflow automation via natural language. Another differentiator for SageMaker Unified Studio is its project-based collaboration model. Projects serve as containers for code, data assets, and compute resources, enabling teams to share notebooks, SQL queries, and data products, all with integrated version control and role-based access.

The platform's extensibility, deep integration with AWS' ecosystem, and unified approach to data and AI development position it as a compelling choice for organizations seeking to modernize and consolidate their analytics and AI workflows.

Progress Software

The Progress Data Platform represents Progress Software's strategic move to unify a diverse set of data management, integration, and enrichment technologies into a cohesive platform designed to address the persistent challenges organizations face in harnessing value from their data assets. The platform is a deep integration of established products, most notably MarkLogic for multimodal data management and Semaphore for semantic enrichment, augmented by additional Progress offerings such

as DataDirect for connectivity, Corticon for business rules management, and new orchestration and visualization tools. This architectural approach is intended to provide customers with an end-to-end solution for data ingestion, enrichment, governance, and consumption, with an emphasis on supporting AI-ready data operations.

The Progress Data Platform stands out for its ability to manage both structured and unstructured data at scale, supporting real-time transactional and analytical workloads across diverse industries such as manufacturing, media, healthcare, and the public sector. MarkLogic serves as the core engine, enabling operational repositories, data hubs, knowledge graphs, and analytics within a unified environment. This is enhanced by Semaphore's semantic modeling, which delivers metadata management and facilitates knowledge graph creation. The platform's composable architecture and integrated AI capabilities, including vector search, retrieval-augmented generation, and agentic AI, support tailored solutions for both technical and business users. Flexible deployment and pricing models further broaden its appeal.

The Progress Data Platform did not qualify for this IDC MarketScape evaluation due to not meeting regional revenue distribution requirements. However, the company's strengths lie in its robust support for multimodal data, advanced semantic enrichment, and a flexible, modular approach that enables organizations to address the full life cycle of data management and AI readiness. This positions Progress Software as a notable vendor for organizations seeking to modernize their data infrastructure, particularly where the integration of structured and unstructured data, semantic enrichment, and operational scalability are critical requirements.

Starburst

Starburst is a modern data platform designed to help organizations query, analyze, and govern data across heterogeneous, distributed environments. Built on Trino, the open source distributed SQL query engine originally developed by the company's founders, Starburst provides federated query capabilities across more than 50 sources, including data lakes, relational databases, cloud object storage, and on-premises systems.

Rather than consolidating data into a single platform, Starburst enables in-place analytics as an abstraction layer between the underlying data sources and users. This reduces the need for costly and time-consuming data migrations, allowing users to access data where it resides while enforcing governance and security policies centrally. The platform is available in two primary deployment models: Starburst Galaxy, a fully managed SaaS offering on all major cloud providers; and Starburst Enterprise, a self-managed solution suitable for regulated or complex environments that require custom infrastructure control, including air-gapped deployments.

Starburst offers strong alignment with open data lakehouse architectures, particularly through its deep integration with Apache Iceberg. Iceberg support includes features such as table versioning, schema evolution, and ACID transactions, enabling reliable, large-scale data management across varied environments. The platform also introduces AI-enablement features, including support for LLM-specific capabilities such as vector search, prompt execution via SQL, and model governance. These features are intended to help enterprises develop AI applications and agent workflows while maintaining performance, policy enforcement, and compliance standards.

While Starburst offers many of the capabilities associated with modern data platforms, it did not qualify for this IDC MarketScape evaluation due to its primary focus on data virtualization rather than owning a native, dedicated storage layer. Nevertheless, its strengths in federated data access and open architecture and ability to unify analytics and AI workloads position it as a strong vendor to watch for organizations pursuing decentralized data strategies, especially those operating in hybrid or multicloud environments.

APPENDIX

Reading an IDC MarketScape Graph

For the purposes of this analysis, IDC divided potential key measures for success into two primary categories: capabilities and strategies.

Positioning on the y-axis reflects the vendor's current capabilities and menu of services and how well aligned the vendor is to customer needs. The capabilities category focuses on the capabilities of the company and product today, here and now. Under this category, IDC analysts will look at how well a vendor is building/delivering capabilities that enable it to execute its chosen strategy in the market.

Positioning on the x-axis, or strategies axis, indicates how well the vendor's future strategy aligns with what customers will require in three to five years. The strategies category focuses on high-level decisions and underlying assumptions about offerings, customer segments, and business and go-to-market plans for the next three to five years.

The size of the individual vendor markers in the IDC MarketScape represents the market share of each individual vendor within the specific market segment being assessed.

IDC MarketScape Methodology

IDC MarketScape criteria selection, weightings, and vendor scores represent well-researched IDC judgment about the market and specific vendors. IDC analysts tailor the range of standard characteristics by which vendors are measured through structured discussions, surveys, and interviews with market leaders, participants, and end users. Market weightings are based on user interviews, buyer surveys, and the input of IDC experts in each market. IDC analysts base individual vendor scores, and ultimately vendor positions on the IDC MarketScape, on detailed surveys and interviews with the vendors, publicly available information, and end-user experiences in an effort to provide an accurate and consistent assessment of each vendor's characteristics, behavior, and capability.

Market Definition

Data platform software is a comprehensive solution designed to manage the entire data life cycle, from collection to analysis, providing a unified environment for handling vast amounts of diverse data. Composed of five foundational layers — dedicated data storage, data integration, data transformation, data intelligence, and data analysis — it offers scalable storage solutions, centralizes data from various sources, prepares it for analysis, ensures quality and governance, and supports powerful querying and analysis tools. By seamlessly integrating these layers and the first three planes of the enterprise intelligence architecture (i.e., data, data control, and data synthesis) into a single product, data platform software empowers the management of an organization's entire data ecosystem, enabling data-driven decision-making and fostering innovation across the enterprise.

Strategies and Capabilities Criteria

The assessment criteria are divided into two primary categories of strategies and capabilities for the success of the data platform evaluation (see Tables 1 and 2). IDC analysts look at how well a vendor is building/delivering capabilities that enable it to execute its chosen strategy in the market. Strategies scoring looks at a vendor's financial strength, partner network, market growth, innovation, product road map, customer engagement, and the ability to deliver on its promises. The core capabilities evaluated in this IDC MarketScape were centered around the following: data storage, data integration, data transformation, data intelligence, and data analysis. These categories were all weighted equally across the capabilities axis, demonstrating that data platform software must prioritize all parts of the data life cycle. For key capabilities, IDC not only evaluated the native capabilities offered in the data platform but also considered third-party and partner-extended capabilities that were natively connected and supported by the vendor.

Vendors provided reference customers that participated in interviews and an evaluation survey, responding to questions about vendor strategies and product capabilities.

TABLE 1

Key Strategy Measures for Success: Worldwide Data Platform Software

Strategies Criteria	Definitions	Weight (%)
Financial/funding	The vendor has enough capital or budget to execute product road map, as well as go-to-market strategies. The vendor is established in the global market and well known in the data management space.	24.0
Partner ecosystem	The vendor has a strong channel partner strategy, which is primed to fuel growth. The vendor supports a range of personas and deployment options.	16.0
Growth and momentum	The vendor has strong indicators of market momentum including mindshare and market share. The vendor has undergone significant milestones in the past year and has realistic geographical, industry, and company size expansion plans.	14.0
Innovation	The vendor has mature R&D processes that are likely to contribute to further financial results. The vendor has meaningful planned use of AI to further automate and enhance offering capabilities.	13.0
Functionality or offering	The vendor's product road map is realistic, achievable, and attuned to client needs. The vendor supports a wide range of security and privacy standards and regulations. The vendor has planned improvements to capabilities, architecture, support, and monitoring to enable stronger benefits while reducing risk.	19.0
Customer engagement	It includes customer's onboarding approach and process combined with ongoing engagement methods.	9.0
Customer delivery strategy	It includes the customer's perceptions and knowledge of the vendor's product road map, continuous innovation toward intelligent automation, and ability to communicate and collaborate strategically with customers.	5.0
Total		100.0

Source: IDC, 2025

TABLE 2

Key Capability Measures for Success: Worldwide Data Platform Software

Capabilities Criteria	Definitions	Weight (%)
Product	The platform has been generally available in the market for enough time and has accumulated/maintained substantial revenue and customers.	13.0
Functionality or offering (data storage)	The platform supports a wide range of storage architectures with advanced scaling, cost optimization, and disaster recovery capabilities. The platform is interoperable with open table format support.	15.0
Functionality or offering (data integration)	The platform has a wide range of data formats supported for processing and data sources natively integrated. The platform monitors complex data integration pipelines and performs both batch and real-time data processing.	15.0
Functionality or offering (data transformation)	The platform has native or partner-provided (with prebuilt integration) capabilities to profile, match, and cleanse data in batch and continuous processing modes.	15.0
Functionality or offering (data intelligence)	The platform has data ownership, stewardship, audit logging and policy creation, approval, and enforcement capabilities with security/privacy certifications. The platform has advanced data cataloging and lineage tracking capabilities.	15.0
Functionality or offering (data analysis and exploration)	The platform is accessible across personas with capabilities for advanced analytics, data visualization, high-performance querying, model training, agentic AI, and so forth. The platform has the ability to create data products and enable a shop for data experience for data consumers.	15.0
Cost and flexibility	The vendor has flexible pricing models for different types of delivery, such as cloud, on premises, per user, and enterprise, which align well with value delivery to customers.	8.0
Customer satisfaction	The customers demonstrate high levels of satisfaction and are strong advocates for their chosen platform. The vendor provides a holistic and comprehensive approach to customer success based on value delivered, ease of use, performance, and implementation experience.	4.0
Total		100.0

Source: IDC, 2025

LEARN MORE

Related Research

- *How Artificial Intelligence Is Changing Data Management* (IDC #US53612925, July 2025)
- *Data's Future: Platforms, Products, and Possibilities — Navigating the Evolution of Data for a Smarter Future* (IDC #DIR2025_TECHC_SB, May 2025)
- *Defining Data Repositories for Analytics, 2025: Technology Buyers' Guide* (IDC #US52743725, January 2025)
- *IDC Market Glance: Data Platforms, 4Q24* (IDC #US52596024, December 2024)
- *AI-Ready Data: Foundation for AI-Fueled Business* (IDC #US52607724, September 2024)

Synopsis

This IDC study evaluates the evolving data platform software market, driven by the need to navigate the increasingly fragmented data and AI landscape. It highlights 11 vendors — Cloudera, Databricks, Google, Hewlett Packard Enterprise, IBM, InterSystems, Microsoft, Oracle, SAP, Snowflake, and Teradata — assessing their strengths, challenges, and suitability for various data management and analytics initiatives. The document underscores the importance of data storage, integration, transformation, intelligence, and analysis to support all parts of the data life cycle.

"AI demands and data complexity are reshaping decisions," says Marlanna Bozicevich, senior research analyst, Data Platform research at IDC. "Modern data platforms must unify governance and support interoperability across the entire data landscape".

ABOUT IDC

International Data Corporation (IDC) is the premier global provider of market intelligence, advisory services, and events for the information technology, telecommunications, and consumer technology markets. With more than 1,300 analysts worldwide, IDC offers global, regional, and local expertise on technology, IT benchmarking and sourcing, and industry opportunities and trends in over 110 countries. IDC's analysis and insight helps IT professionals, business executives, and the investment community to make fact-based technology decisions and to achieve their key business objectives. Founded in 1964, IDC is a wholly owned subsidiary of International Data Group (IDG, Inc.).

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